CHAPTER 1

THE BACKGROUND TO MILITANCY IN PAKISTAN BEFORE 2001

THE GENESIS

Muslim struggles always adopt a religious hue. Evidently, in all wars and conquests, they display Islamic symbols, raise Islamic war slogans (Allah-o-Akbar, God is Great) and fight with religious zeal that emanated from the concept of Jihad and *shahadat* (martyrdom). Whether it be Tariq bin Ziad who conquered Spain (AD 711), Muhammad bin Qasim who defeated Raja Dahir to conquer Sindh (AD 712) or Mahmud Ghaznavi who launched 17 successful attacks on India (1001–26), their campaigns have shown palpable religious motivation or tint. In fact, whether for independence or an invasion either for the sake of invading or for their constitutional rights, every struggle of Muslims throughout the world has invariably taken a religious turn (Haqqani, 2005). In 1947–8, Akbar Khan, the commander of the Pakistan Army involved in the Kashmir military operation, adopted the nom de guerre of Tariq after the Muslim conqueror of Spain, Tariq Bin Ziyad. It is no wonder that the tribesmen who aided this operation were full of the notion of jihad.

Another historically proven peculiar phenomenon is that whenever Muslims are repressed, movements for Islamic revival take place. For the past 250 years, the Muslim world has been subjected to invasion and conquest by foreign powers, creating an inevitable anti-colonial